

Prayers for our World and the Church

27th September 2026

Phil 4:6-7 ESVUK

6 do not be anxious about anything, but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known to God.

7 And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that You are the God of Peace, and You have made peace with us by sending Jesus to deal with our broken relationship with You. As sinners inheriting the sin of Adam, who first turned away from full obedience, and following in his footsteps, we know our guilt and carry an impossible burden. We thank You that we have been forgiven by Your grace and mercy alone, and have been set free from sin. We are still aware of our weakness and bias towards sin, living in a world still operating under the effects of the Curse.

We thank You for sending the Holy Spirit, enabling us to resist temptation, opening our minds to Your Word, and sanctifying us so that we grow more like Jesus each day.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We pray for this world where so many still hide from the Truth, still hate Your people, both Jewish and Christian, and suppress the truth in unrighteousness as Your Word warns us. It is hard to understand how badly satan has blinded them, and how they believe his lies and refuse to turn to the Truth.

We pray for the church, Your people everywhere, to declare the truth boldly but graciously. We thank You for those parts of the visible church where there is a strong stand for the truth, a firm witness to the Resurrected Jesus, and an unshakeable trust in the Presence of the Holy Spirit, so that people would turn back to You.

We pray strength for Your church, for the peace of Jerusalem and courage for Your persecuted people in many other places, who face daily anxiety because of opposition and life-threatening terrorist attacks. We pray as well for churches which have lost their way, and fallen under the influence of these godless modern times.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, as we labour in the work of the Kingdom. We pray for discernment and wisdom to recognise the wiles of the enemy, who works in less obvious ways, always seeking to undo Your great work of salvation in this land where we live mostly at peace. Guide us as we speak words of life to those we meet day by day.

We pray for the Selection Committee as they seek Your wisdom, and work on our behalf to call a new minister of Your choosing, to bring us Your Word and sacraments.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand – for Joan, John & Gaye, Diane, Levi and others affected by illness or injury.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Brett as he preaches today. We pray that we would be diligent hearers and do-ers of Your Word, making the most of the means of grace.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.